

Guardianship Tentative Rulings

June 22, 2026

8:30 a.m.

Department 42

The Court's Self Help Center is available by phone and email to assist Guardians and Petitioners. The Self-Help Center does not assist with Guardianships of the Estate. Please see the Court's website for updated information and contact information for the Court's Self Help Center.

To appear through WebEx, please follow these instructions:

Call 1-(844) 517-1271 between 8:20 – 8:30 a.m.

The access code is 1464798527 There is no attendee ID number, so just follow verbal instructions for prompt.

Once you have gained access, wait for the court to start the calendar. Please follow these instructions once a calendar is called:

- 1. Please mute your telephone until your case is called;**
- 2. Please do not place the call on hold;**
- 3. Minimize all background noise during your call;**
- 4. Please identify yourself, each time, prior to speaking with the court;**
- 5. Disconnect when the court has completed your case or cases;**
- 6. The court prohibits the recording of these proceedings**

GUARDIANSHIP OF JURON & JOSIAH ANDERSON

CASE NUMBER: 26PG-0033257

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings on a Petition for Appointment of Guardian of the Person. The Petition was filed by the minors' grandmother, Amy Rodgers. Letters of Temporary Guardianship were requested but denied pending hearing.

Based on the declaration filed on May 29, 2026, the Court will dispense with notice to the paternal grandfather. A declaration was filed on May 29, 2026, which states that the siblings Johnae and Johnia are the same person. Proof of service has been filed for the sibling, Johnae. The Court notes that the father has consented to the guardianship and waived notice. The matter has been properly noticed. No objections have been raised. ICWA notification has been given and no tribe has requested to intervene in this matter.

The Court has reviewed and considered the Court Investigator's report filed on March 24, 2026, which states that the investigation did not establish a sufficient basis to support guardianship. In light of the

report, the Court appoints private counsel to represent the minors pursuant to Probate Code Section 1470. The matter is continued to **Monday, July 20, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. in Department 42** for confirmation of counsel and setting of an evidentiary hearing. **No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF MADDISON CHAPMAN-JAMES

CASE NUMBER: CVPG18-0029612

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings on the Petition to Remove Guardian and Petition for Appointment of Successor Guardian of the Person. The Petitions were filed by the minor's aunt, Amanda Cossairt. Letters of Temporary Guardianship issued to Ms. Cossairt on July 7, 2025, and are set to expire today unless further extended. The current Guardian is Shannon Schottel, whose authority has been suspended.

The Court previously found the Petition to Remove Guardian has been properly noticed. The father has consented to the appointment of the Successor Guardian and waived notice. The Petition for Appointment of a Successor Guardian of the Person has been properly noticed. The Court has reviewed the Court Investigator's report filed on May 23, 2025, which recommends granting the Petition. ICWA notification has been properly given, and no tribe has requested to intervene in this matter. The mother previously filed an objection, and counsel has been appointed for the minor. **An appearance is necessary on today's calendar for setting of a contested hearing.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF ONNIE COLEMAN

CASE NUMBER: 23PG-0032266

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings on a Petition for Termination of Guardianship filed by the mother, Savannah Michener. The matter has been properly noticed with proof of service on file. No objections have been raised. The Court has reviewed and considered the Court Investigator's report filed on June 9, 2026, and agrees with the recommendation to grant the Petition. The Petition is **GRANTED**. A proposed Order has been submitted and will be executed by the Court. Upon execution of the order, the clerk is instructed to close the file and vacate all future dates. **No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF ARA FAIR-SPENCER

CASE NUMBER: CVPG11-0026971

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings regarding status of final distribution. Proof of distribution has not been filed for the three former minors. The matter is continued to **Monday, July 27, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. in Department 42** for further proceedings regarding status of final distribution. If proof of final distribution cannot be filed prior to the next hearing, the Court **ORDERS** a Status Report be filed and served at least five court days before the next hearing date to advise what must be accomplished before proof of distribution can be filed. **No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF ALDEN GIGAX & CIAN JUSTINGER

CASE NUMBER: CVPG19-0030230

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings on a Petition for Appointment of Successor Guardian of the Persons filed by the minors' uncle, Ridge Gigax. Letters of Temporary Guardianship were issued on March 26, 2026, and are set to expire today unless further extended. The current Guardian is Patricia Schoepflin, who has passed away. This matter is also on calendar for hearing on a Petition for Termination of Guardianship filed by the mother, Falon Gigax.

Petition for Appointment of Successor Guardian. A new Notice of Hearing has not been filed and served for today's date. There is no proof of service of the Notice of Hearing and Petition for the paternal grandparents of Alden or paternal grandparents of Cian and insufficient information has been provided to permit the Court to dispense with notice to these parties. All remaining parties may be served by mail. The Court has reviewed the Court Investigator's report filed on April 21, 2026, which recommends granting the Petition. The mother previously filed an objection. The Court will appoint private counsel to represent the minors pursuant to Probate Code Section 1470.

Petition for Termination. The Court will dispense with notice to the deceased Guardian/maternal grandmother. There is no proof of service of the Notice of Hearing and Petition for the temporary guardian, minor Alden, father of Alden, father of Cian, maternal grandfather, paternal grandparents of Alden, or paternal grandparents of Cian. Insufficient information has been provided to permit the Court to dispense with notice to these parties. All parties may be served by mail. The Court has reviewed the Court Investigator's report filed on June 11, 2026, which recommends the Court deny the Petition.

The matter is continued to **Monday, July 27, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. in Department 42** for further proceedings on the Petition for Appointment of a Successor Guardian of the Persons, Petition for Termination of Guardianship, and confirmation of counsel. The Temporary Guardianship is **ORDERED** to remain in effect until the continued hearing date. Each Petitioner is required to file and serve a new Notice of Hearing for the continued hearing date, along with a copy of their respective Petition, on the parties identified above. In the alternative, if Petitioners cannot serve the parties identified, the Court will require a declaration from each Petitioner explaining in detail all efforts of Petitioners to locate and serve them and why they cannot be served, to permit the Court to dispense with notice. **Warning: Failure to properly effect service or provide adequate basis to dispense with service as to the necessary parties will result in denial of the Petition. Notice is preserved. No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF LILYANNA & LOYALTY LAKE

CASE NUMBER: 26PG-0033332

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings on a Petition for Appointment of Guardian of the Persons. The Petition was filed by the minors' non-relative caregivers Kevin Arias and Syan Joiner. Letters of Temporary Guardianship issued on April 10, 2026, and are set to expire today unless further extended. This matter is also on calendar for confirmation of counsel.

No proof of service has been filed for the father of each minor and insufficient information has been provided to permit the Court to dispense with notice. The Court notes a proof of service was filed on June 11, 2026, for Joel Croy and Vong Vue; however, it is unclear how these individuals are related to the minors. The fathers must be personally served in order to move forward on the Petition. Prob. Code § 1511(b). Alternatively, the fathers can sign a consent and waiver of notice (GC-211, section 4), in lieu of being served.

The Court has reviewed the Children's Services report filed on May 4, 2026, which recommends granting the Petition. ICWA notification has been given. A Notice of Intervention has been filed by the Yurok Tribe on May 20, 2026, and the court confirms the tribe's intervention. The mother previously filed an objection and the Public Defender has been appointed for the minors.

The matter is continued to **Monday, July 27, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. in Department 42** for further proceedings on the Petition for Appointment of Guardian of the Persons and confirmation of counsel. The Temporary Guardianship is **ORDERED** to remain in effect until the continued hearing date. Petitioners are required

to file and serve a new Notice of Hearing for the continued hearing date, along with a copy of the Petition, on the parties identified above. In the alternative, if Petitioners cannot serve the parties identified, the Court will require a declaration explaining in detail all efforts of Petitioners to locate and serve them and why they cannot be served, to permit the Court to dispense with notice. **Warning: Failure to properly effect service or provide adequate basis to dispense with service as to the necessary parties will result in denial of the Petition. Notice is preserved. No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF KIARA LIRA-WILSON

CASE NUMBER: CVPG21-0030977

This matter is on calendar for Annual Review. The Confidential Guardianship Status Report has not been submitted. **The Guardian is ORDERED to appear at today's hearing and submit the Annual Status Report at the time of the hearing. Failure to do so may result in the issuance of an Order to Show Cause why Monetary Sanctions in the amount of \$250.00 should not be ordered for violating the Court's order to appear and to file the report.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF KAIDIN MASON

CASE NUMBER: CVPG14-0027851

The matter is on calendar for further proceedings on the Annual Review. This matter is also on calendar for hearing on an Order to Show Cause issued to the Guardian for failure to appear on May 11, 2026, to discuss the Status Report. No response to the Order to Show Cause has been filed. **An appearance is necessary on today's calendar to discuss the Status Report. Warning: Failure to appear on today's calendar will result in the issuance of both monetary sanctions in the sum of \$250.00, and an Order to Show Cause re: Termination of Guardianship.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF RUBY & HA'PEECH MCCRANEY

CASE NUMBER: CVPG18-0029719

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings on the Annual Review and Order to Show Cause issued to the Guardian for failure to file the Confidential Guardianship Status Reports and failure to appear on March 2, 2026. The Confidential Status Reports have not been submitted. No response to the Order to Show Cause has been filed.

This matter is also on calendar for hearing on a Petition for Appointment of a Successor Guardian of the Persons and Estate. The Petition was filed by the minors' non-relative care providers, Jacob and Vania Wright. Letters of Temporary Guardianship as to the person only were issued on May 15, 2026, and are set to expire today unless further extended. The current Guardian is Deseriee Goodman.

The father has been personally served. There is no valid proof of service of the Notice of Hearing and Petition on the minors, Guardian, mother, maternal grandparents, or paternal grandparents. Insufficient information has been provided to permit the Court to dispense with notice to these parties. The proof of service by mail for the Guardian and mother filed on May 14, 2026, is insufficient. The minors, Guardian, and mother must be personally served in order to move forward on the Petition. Prob. Code § 1511(b). All other parties may be served by mail. Prob. Code § 1511(c). Alternatively, the above parties can sign a consent and waiver of notice (GC-211, section 4), in lieu of being served.

The Court notes Probate Code Section 2670 provides that a successor guardian may be appointed, "[w]hen for any reason a vacancy occurs in the office of guardian." There is no vacancy in the office of guardian and a Petition to Remove Guardian has not been filed. The Confidential Guardian Screening Form (GC-

212) for both Jacob and Vania are incomplete as to item 6. The Court notes the ICWA-010(A) indicates that the minor children are unsure of any tribal affiliations; however the Court notes ICWA notification was properly given regarding Ms. Goodman's Petition (also a non-relative care provider) and no tribe requested to intervene in the matter.

This matter is continued to **Monday, July 27, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. in Department 42** for further proceedings on the Annual Review, Order to Show Cause, and Petition for Appointment of a Successor Guardian of the Persons and Estate. The Temporary Guardianship is **ORDERED** to remain in effect until the continued hearing date. An amended Confidential Guardian Screening Form is required to be filed by each Petition to address the issues raised above. Petitioner are required to file and serve a properly noticed Petition to Remove Guardian. Petitioners are also required to file and serve a new Notice of Hearing for the continued hearing date, along with a copy of the Petition, on the parties identified above. In the alternative, if Petitioners cannot serve the parties identified, the Court will require a declaration explaining in detail all efforts of Petitioners to locate and serve them and why they cannot be served, to permit the Court to dispense with notice. **Warning: Failure to properly effect service or provide adequate basis to dispense with service as to the necessary parties will result in denial of the Petition. Notice is preserved. No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF EVAN NEWTON

CASE NUMBER: CVPG16-0028649

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings on a Petition for Video/Phone Visitation filed by the paternal grandmother, Brenda Newton. **An appearance is necessary on today's calendar for status of visitation.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF MIABELLA PRESTA

CASE NUMBER: 25PG-0032885

This matter is on calendar for Annual Review. The Confidential Guardianship Status Report has not been submitted. **The Guardian is ORDERED to appear at today's hearing and submit the Annual Status Report at the time of the hearing. Failure to do so may result in the issuance of an Order to Show Cause why Monetary Sanctions in the amount of \$250.00 should not be ordered for violating the Court's order to appear and to file the report.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF EMILIO, JULIO & SERGIO RAMOS

CASE NUMBER: 24PG-0032518

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings on a Petition for Visitation filed by the minor's parent, Jose Ramos. Proof of service has been filed for the Public Defender. The matter has been properly noticed. No objections have been raised. **An appearance is necessary on today's calendar to discuss the status of visitation.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF JUSTIN & CALI THALLMAYER

CASE NUMBER: 24PG-0032457

This matter is on calendar for Annual Review. The Confidential Guardianship Status Reports have been accepted by the Court; however, the matter remains on calendar by request of the Guardian to discuss guardianship of the estate. **An appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF SAMEER VERMA

CASE NUMBER: 26PG-0033388

This matter is on calendar for hearing a Petition for Appointment of Guardian of the Person. The Petition was filed by the ward, Sameer Verma, and requests that non-relative caregiver, Deepak Bhandari, be appointed as guardian. Temporary Letters have not issued. The matter is also on calendar for hearing on a Petition for Special Immigrant Juvenile Findings.

Petition for Appointment of Guardian. The guardian, mother, father, and sibling have consented to the guardianship and waived notice. The Court dispenses with notice to the deceased maternal and paternal grandparents. The matter has been properly noticed. No objections have been raised and the paperwork appears to be in order. The Court has reviewed the Children's Services Report filed on June 12, 2026, which recommends the Petition be granted. The Court **FINDS** it would be detrimental for the ward to be with either parent or any parent objecting to the guardianship, the guardianship is in the ward's best interest, and the guardianship is necessary and convenient. The proposed guardian is suitable. The Court **GRANTS** the Petition for Guardianship. A proposed Order Appointing Guardian has been lodged and will be executed by the Court. The Guardianship will terminate by operation of law when the ward turns 21 years of age.

Petition for Special Immigrant Juvenile Findings. The guardian, mother, and father consented to the Petition and waived notice. The matter has been properly noticed. No objections have been raised and the paperwork appears to be in order. The Court **FINDS** that the ward has been placed under the custody of Deepak Bhandari, that reunification with the mother or father is not viable under California law because of abuse, neglect, and parental abandonment, and that it is not in the best interest of the ward to be returned to India (the country of the ward's nationality). The Court will execute the proposed Order. **No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF AZELIEGHA VOROBETS

CASE NUMBER: 26PG-0033309

This matter is on calendar for further proceedings on a Petition for Appointment of Guardian of the Person filed by the minor's uncle, Bryan Padua. This matter is also on calendar for hearing on a Petition for Appointment of Guardian of the Person filed by the minor's stepmother and grandmother, Vita Vorobets and Svetlana Vorobets. Temporary Letters have not issued.

Padua Petition. The Court previously determined the matter to be properly noticed. The Court has reviewed the Court Investigator's report filed on April 14, 2026, which recommends granting the Petition. The father, stepmother, and paternal grandmother have filed objections to Mr. Padua's Petition.

Vorobets Petition. The Court dispenses with notice to the unknown paternal grandfather. Proof of service has been filed for the maternal grandparents and Bryan Padua. There is no valid proof of service of the Notice of Hearing and Petition on mother or father. The parents must be personally served in order to move forward on the Petition. Prob. Code § 1511(b). Alternatively, the above parties can sign a consent and waiver of notice (GC-211, section 4) in lieu of being served. The Court has reviewed the Court Investigator's report filed on May 27, 2026, which recommends the Court deny the Petition.

This matter is also on calendar for confirmation of counsel and for hearing on a Motion Declining Appointment and Request to be Relieved as Counsel. The Public Defender was previously appointed as counsel for the minor; however, they have indicated they are declining appointment. The matter has

been properly noticed with proof of service on file. No objections have been raised. The Court accepts their declination of representation and appoints private counsel pursuant to Probate Code Section 1470.

The Court will inquire whether the child is or may be an Indian child. If Petitioners have reason to know that the child is an Indian child, they must make further inquiry to learn about the child's Indian heritage. This matter is continued to **Monday, July 20, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. in Department 42** for further proceedings on the Petition filed by Brian Padua, the Petition filed by Vita and Svetlana Vorobets, and confirmation of counsel. Vita and Svetlana Vorobets are required to file and serve a new Notice of Hearing for the continued hearing date, along with a copy of the Petition, on the parties identified above. In the alternative, if they cannot serve the parties identified, the Court will require a declaration explaining in detail all efforts to locate and serve them and why they cannot be served, to permit the Court to dispense with notice. **Warning: Failure to properly effect service or provide adequate basis to dispense with service as to the necessary parties will result in denial of the Petition. Notice is preserved. No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**